



FREE GUIDE · FOR CORRECTIONAL PHARMACIES

The Correctional Pharmacy's Guide to Compliant Disposal.

Secure chain-of-custody destruction for
controlled substances and pharmacy waste.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Security first, compliance always.

Correctional pharmacies operate under heightened security — controlled substances and medications require secure, documented chain-of-custody from your facility to destruction. Diversion risk makes the paper trail non-negotiable. This guide covers every stream and the secure handling correctional settings demand.

The good news

We provide secure, documented chain-of-custody destruction for correctional pharmacy waste — controlled and non-controlled — with Form 222/41, non-retrievable destruction, and audit-ready Certificates of Destruction. No contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Controlled substances

Schedule II–V stock and returns — the stream where secure chain-of-custody matters most.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused Schedule II–V stock
- Returns of controls (per program)
- Partial & wasted doses

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — Form 222 for Schedule II transfers, Form 41 for surrendered controls, and non-retrievable destruction with records.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled-substance mail-back / reverse distribution, to DEA standards.

Tip

We're a DEA-registered reverse distributor — the credential that makes taking back your controls legal.

WASTE STREAM 02

Pharmaceutical waste (non-hazardous)

Expired non-controlled, non-hazardous medications.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired non-controlled, non-hazardous Rx
- OTC & compounded non-haz product
- Samples

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances
- RCRA-hazardous drugs
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit.

Tip

Segregate hazardous and controlled drugs first — everything else routes here.

WASTE STREAM 03

RCRA-hazardous drugs

P/U-listed and characteristic hazardous drugs.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- P-listed (warfarin $\geq 0.3\%$, nicotine, epinephrine)
- U-listed drugs
- Characteristic waste (ignitable, toxic)
- Certain chemotherapy agents

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-hazardous pharmaceuticals
- Controlled substances (own path)

THE RULE · EPA RCRA — identify P/U-listed and characteristic drugs, segregate, and destroy to EPA standards; know your generator status.

DISPOSE WITH · RCRA-hazardous mail-back kit.

Tip

Nicotine and epinephrine are P-listed — easy to miss and a common citation.

WASTE STREAM 04

Reverse distribution & returns

Returnable expired and unused stock, recovered for credit.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused returnable Rx
- Overstock & discontinued inventory
- Manufacturer recalls
- Brand & generic stock

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Opened / adulterated product (destroy only)
- Patient-owned meds
- Sharps

THE RULE · Returnable items are processed for manufacturer credit; non-returnable items are rendered non-retrievable with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical reverse distribution — credit recovered, the rest destroyed.

Tip

Items you'd have thrown away may still be credit-eligible — don't pre-sort them into the trash.

WASTE STREAM 05

Sharps

From infirmary and facility-administered injectables.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Immunization needles & syringes
- Lancets
- Point-of-care testing sharps

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-sharp meds
- Bloody gauze (biohazard)

THE RULE · OSHA — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers; annual training if staff are exposed.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit.

Tip

Immunizing pharmacies generate more sharps than they expect — size accordingly.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The correctional pharmacy compliance checklist.

- ☐ Controlled substances secured, logged, and rendered non-retrievable with Form 41 and chain-of-custody.
- ☐ Every wasted controlled dose witnessed and documented.
- ☐ Non-controlled and hazardous drugs segregated and destroyed with documentation.
- ☐ Returnable stock recovered for credit via reverse distribution.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction and chain-of-custody records retained per your rules.

QUESTIONS CORRECTIONAL PHARMACIES ASK

Your correctional pharmacy questions, answered.

How do you ensure secure chain-of-custody?

Controlled substances are tracked and documented from your facility through non-retrievable destruction, with Form 41 and chain-of-custody records — built for diversion-sensitive settings.

How are controlled substances destroyed?

Rendered non-retrievable with Form 222/41 and witnessed logs by a DEA-registered reverse distributor.

Do you provide audit-ready documentation?

Yes — Certificates of Destruction and chain-of-custody records for every batch.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle handles pharmacy waste by prepaid mail-back or scheduled pickup for higher volume. Returnable Rx is processed for manufacturer credit; controlled and non-controlled waste is destroyed non-retrievable with a Certificate of Destruction. Form 222/41 handled. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Controlled substances	Controlled destruction (Form 41, chain-of-custody)
Non-hazardous Rx	Pharmaceutical waste kit
Hazardous drugs	RCRA-hazardous mail-back kit
Returnable stock	Reverse distribution (credit)
Sharps	Sharps mail-back kit

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Correctional settings usually require scheduled, secure pickup with full chain-of-custody rather than mail-back. Let's build it — get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY CORRECTIONAL PHARMACIES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order



Ready to simplify your correctional pharmacy waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop